

Qualification content

Knowledge and understanding

The specification content is set out in detail in Topics 1 to 9. The content of this qualification has taken the following points into account, that:

- coverage should touch the main subject areas that are appropriate at this level – the natural environment, resources and production, population and settlement – as well as the related topics of globalisation, human welfare and sustainability
- emphasis should be placed on the relationship between people and the environment
- geography should be recognised as a dynamic discipline in continuous change
- content should be specified in such a way that students can explore the geography of their own countries
- case studies are used to exemplify key ideas
- students are required to undertake fieldwork and other practical exercises to underpin knowledge and understanding, as well as to illustrate the key ideas
- students should become competent in the use of a range of skills and techniques.

Teachers have the freedom to construct their own teaching programme based on this specification, but any programme must fulfil the following requirements:

- the study of a range of themes which, taken together, involve work at different spatial scales (small (local), regional, national, international, global), in different parts of the world and in different types of environment
- the development of skills used in geographical enquiry, including fieldwork investigation.

The content in detail

The specification content pages for each topic are divided into the following sections.

Key ideas

Each topic is divided into a number of key ideas which give a focus to the content.

Essential content

Each key idea is broken down into a number of bulleted content points which specify what must be studied. Examination questions will be based on this content.

Scale

The scale column indicates the spatial scale at which the content should be covered, where appropriate.

Required exemplification

This column indicates case studies that illustrate and support some of the essential content. It is important that the bulleted content should be studied in the context of real places. Students will be expected to demonstrate accurate knowledge of location in the examination.

Fieldwork opportunities and practical skills

This column indicates recommended exercises involving the collection and analysis of primary and secondary data. An essential part of this practical work is using a range of geographical enquiry skills. This practical learning is an integral part of the questions relating to Sections A and B of the specification content. Fieldwork opportunities are identified with an (F) and practical skills are identified with a (P).

Abbreviations used

In the topics the following abbreviations have been used:

BRICS – Brazil, Russia, India, China, South Africa

CBD – Central Business District

GDP – Gross Domestic Product

GNI – Gross National Income

HDI – Human Development Index

HIC – High Income Country

HYV – High Yielding Variety

LIC – Low Income Country

MIC – Medium Income Country

NIC – Newly Industrialised Country

TNC – Transnational Company

Examination Paper

Overview of paper

Section A – The Natural Environment

Candidates are asked to complete two out of three questions based on the three topics:

- 1 River environments
- 2 Coastal environments
- 3 Hazardous environments.

Section B – People and their Environments

Candidates asked to complete two out of three questions based on the three topics:

- 4 Economic activity and energy
- 5 Ecosystems and rural environments
- 6 Urban environments.

Section C – Practical Geographical Enquiry

Candidates asked to complete one out of two questions related to Section A and one out of two questions related to Section B.

Section D – Global Issues

Candidates asked to complete one question drawn from one of the three topics:

- 7 Fragile environments
- 8 Globalisation and migration
- 9 Development and human welfare.

Overview of assessment

- The assessment of this qualification is through a 3-hour examination paper, set and marked by Edexcel.
- The single tier of entry will contain a variety of question types, such as multiple-choice questions, short and extended answer questions, graphical and data questions and fieldwork questions.
- The total number of marks available is 180.
- The paper will be a question and answer booklet and students have to answer:
 - two questions from a choice of three in Section A
 - two questions from a choice of three in Section B
 - two questions; one question from a choice of two related to Topics 1 to 3 and one question from a choice of two related to Topics 4 to 6 in Section C
 - one question from a choice of three in Section D.

		Scale	Required case studies	Recommended fieldwork opportunities (F) and practical skills (P)
teristics, stores and transfers. including watershed and channel mes: factors affecting them and use, water abstraction,		Global and small (local)	1 Case study of the physical features of a drainage basin.	Channel network mapping (P).
ss movement; erosion and these processes (climate, stream ream and the formation of terfalls, meanders, oxbow lakes,		Small (local)		Investigating channel characteristics (F). Annotated sketches based on photographs (P).
, industry, human hygiene and apply of water: areas of water r quality. Sources of pollution iculture). The storage and supply rvoirs; pipelines; treatment rainfall, snowmelt, steep slopes, activities) and control.		National and small (local)	2 Case study of the rising demand for water in one country. 3 Case study of a water storage project to include its construction, management and impacts.	Investigating water quality (F).